// Jacob Jameson

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Education

Harvard University
Ph.D. Health Policy (Decision Sciences Track), 2022–2027 (expected)

University of Chicago
M.S. Computational Analysis and Public Policy, 2020–2022

Johns Hopkins School of Education
Teaching Certification, Secondary Mathematics and Computer Science, 2018–2019

University of California, Santa Cruz
B.A. Economics and Mathematics, 2015–2018

Research Interests

Health care operations, causal inference, machine learning, decision science

References

Soroush Saghafian (Co-Chair)
Associate Professor of Public Policy
Harvard Kennedy School
soroush_saghafian@hks.harvard.edu

Sue Goldie (Co-Chair)
Roger Irving Lee Professor of Public Health
Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health
sue_goldie@harvard.edu

Robert S. Huckman
Albert J. Weatherhead III Professor of Business Administration
Harvard Business School
rhuckman@hbs.edu

Zachary Ward
Assistant Professor of Health Decision Science
Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health
zward@hsph.harvard.edu

Job Market Paper

The Impact of Batching Advanced Imaging Tests in Emergency Departments
Preprint
Jameson, J. C., Saghafian, S., Huckman, R. S., Hodgson, N., & Baugh, J.
Invited 2nd round revision at Management Science

Using detailed electronic health record data of over 150,000 patient encounters from two major U.S. emergency departments (EDs), we examine practice variation across physicians to uncover the operational impact of discretionary batch ordering of imaging tests. We find that quasi-random assignment of a patient to an ED physician with a higher tendency to batch causally increases the patient's length of stay, time to disposition, and the number of imaging tests performed. Discretionary batching increases length of stay by approximately 76%, increases time to disposition by approximately 88%, increases imaging by 0.91 tests per encounter, and has no detectable effect on 72-hour returns requiring admission. Results suggest that discretionary batching may lead to clinical decision- making that introduces bottlenecks in patient flow. Conversely, standard practice, which preserves diagnostic flexibility by allowing information from initial tests to guide subsequent decisions, offers an "information gain" advantage over batch ordering: the information obtained from a prior test allows the elimination of the need to order some future tests. Put together, our findings indicate that discretionary batch ordering is not an efficient strategy for managing diagnostic imaging in emergency care, and interventions to reduce unnecessary batching may improve both operational performance and resource utilization.

Peer-Reviewed Publications

1. Transcranial Magnetic Stimulation Retreatment for Recurrent Depression: A Large Real-World Multisite Cohort Study.
   Acta Psychiatrica Scandinavica, 2026. Paper
   Lyndon, S., Gibbons, J. B., Straub, L., Sung, M., **Jameson, J. C.**, Hathaway, D. B., Mulcahy, D. H., Elliott, C., Wood, R., Ruble, M., Szmulewicz, A. G., Yang, J., Aldis, R., Wyss, R., Wang, P. S., & Siddiqi, S. H.

2. Sex Differences in Life-Course Suicide Rates by State Firearm Policy Environment.
   American Journal of Preventive Medicine, 2025. Paper
   Glasser, N. J., **Jameson, J. C.**, Abou Baker, N., Pollack, H. A., & Tung, E. L.

3. A National Study Among Diverse US Populations of Exposure to Prescription Medications with Evidence-Based Pharmacogenomic Information.
   Clinical Pharmacology & Therapeutics, 2025. Paper
   Saulsberry, L., **Jameson, J. C.**, Gibbons, R. D., Dolan, M. E., Olopade, O. I., & O'Donnell, P. H.

4. Variation in Batch Ordering of Imaging Tests in the Emergency Department and the Impact on Care Delivery.
   Health Services Research, 2025. Paper
   Jameson, J. C., Saghafian, S., Huckman, R. S., & Hodgson, N.

5. Genomic Heterogeneity and Ploidy Identify Patients with Intrinsic Resistance to PD-1 Blockade in Metastatic Melanoma.
   Science Advances, 2024. Paper
   Tarantino, G., Ricker, C. A., Wang, A., Ge, W., Aprati, T. J., Huang, A. Y., Madha, S., Chen, J., Shi, Y., Glettig, M., Feng, C. H., Frederick, D. T., Freeman, S., Holovatska, M. M., Manos, M. P., Zimmer, L., Rösch, A., Zaremba, A., Livingstone, E., **Jameson, J. C.**, Saghafian, S., Lee, A., Zhao, K., Morris, L. G. T., Reardon, B., Park, J., Elmarakeby, H. A., Schilling, B., Giobbie-Hurder, A., Vokes, N. I., Buchbinder, E. I., Flaherty, K. T., Haq, R., Wu, C. J., Boland, G. M., Hodi, F. S., Van Allen, E. M., Schadendorf, D., & Liu, D.

6. Male Gender Expressivity and Diagnosis and Treatment of Cardiovascular Disease Risks in Men.
   JAMA Network Open, 2024. Paper
   Glasser, N. J., **Jameson, J. C.**, Huang, E. S., Kronish, I. M., Lindau, S. T., Peek, M. E., Tung, E. L., & Pollack, H. A.

7. Associations of Adolescent School Social Networks, Gender Norms, and Adolescent-to-Young Adult Changes in Male Gender Expression with Young Adult Substance Use.
   Journal of Adolescent Health, 2024. Paper
   Glasser, N. J., **Jameson, J. C.**, Tung, E. L., Lindau, S. T., & Pollack, H. A.

8. Does the Doctor-Patient Relationship Affect Enrollment in Clinical Research?
   Academic Medicine, 2023. Paper
   Soo, J., **Jameson, J. C.**, Flores, A., Dubin, L., Perish, E., Afzal, A., Berry, G., DiMaggio, V., Krishnamoorthi, V. R., Porter, J., Tang, J., & Meltzer, D.

Research in Progress

9. Reinforcement Learning for Repetitive Transcranial Magnetic Stimulation Protocol Selection in Treatment-Resistant Depression: A Multiclinic Cohort Study
   Invited revision at npj Digital Medicine
   Gibbons, J. B., Leenaerts, N., Siddiqi, S. H., Murphy, S., Straub, L., Hathaway, D. B., Yang, J., Szmulewicz, A. G., Sung, M., Aldis, R., **Jameson, J. C.**, Wyss, R., Wood, R., Ruble, M., Elliott, C., Mulcahy, D. H., Lyndon, S., & Wang, P. S.

10. Effectiveness of Extreme Risk Protection Orders in Reducing Firearm Deaths.
Invited revision at NEJM Evidence
Jameson, J. C., Pollack, H. A., & Glasser, N. J.

11. Machine Learning to Personalize Psychotherapy Selection for Patients at Elevated Suicide Risk in a Large National Cohort
Under review
Jameson, J. C., Gibbons, J., Sung, M., Hathaway, D., Straub, L., Aldis, R., Lyndon, S., & Wang, P.

12. The Effect of Legalizing Online Sports Gambling on Population Mental Health.
Under review Preprint
Kavanagh, N. M., **Jameson, J. C.**, Pollack, H. A., & Glasser, N. J.

13. Bayesian Anchored Latent Learning for Estimating State Trajectories
Under review
Gibbons, J. B., Leenaerts, N., Mandavia, A. D., **Jameson, J. C.**, Liang, A., Hathaway, D. B., Yang, J., Gu, B., Marx, B. P., Siddiqi, S. H., Wood, R., Ruble, M., Lyndon, S., & Wang, P. S.

14. What Constitutes a Good Biomarker in Cancer Treatment: A Counterfactual Decision-Making Framework
In preparation
Jameson, J. C., Saghafian, S., Liu, D., Tarantino, G., & Gusev, S.

15. Optimizing Scarce Clinician Engagement in Partner Notification for Sexually Transmitted Infections
In preparation
Jameson, J. C., Saghafian, S., & Jónasson, J. O.

Research Funding

2024–present: National Research Service Award (NRSA) T32 Predoctoral Fellowship, National Institute of Mental Health (T32 MH125815), Brigham and Women's Hospital Comparative Effectiveness Research in Suicide Prevention; Trainee; PIs: Miguel Hernán, Matthew Nock, Philip Wang

2026: Dissertation Completion Fellowship, Harvard University

2026: Novartis Fund Project Award, Center for Health Decision Science, Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health

2026: Novartis Fund Conference Award, Center for Health Decision Science, Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health

2026: Graduate Student Council Conference Grant, Harvard University

2024: Howard Raiffa Research Fund, Center for Health Decision Science, Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health

2022: Howard Raiffa Research Fund, Center for Health Decision Science, Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health

Awards and Honors

2026: Distinction in Student Teaching Award, Harvard Kennedy School
2026: Dean's Award for Excellence in Student Teaching, Harvard Kennedy School
2026: Selected Participant, IOE-ISyE-MS&E Rising Stars Workshop, University of Michigan. Winner of People's Choice Award for Presentation
2026: Finalist, Harvard GSAS Three Minute Thesis (3MT®) Competition

2025: Distinction in Student Teaching Award, Harvard Kennedy School
2025: Finalist, INFORMS Health Applications Society Best Student Paper Competition

2024: Dean's Award for Excellence in Student Teaching, Harvard Kennedy School
2024: Distinction in Student Teaching Award, Harvard Kennedy School
2024: Educational Innovation Scholar, Center for Health Decision Science, Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health

2023: Finalist, INFORMS Public Sector Operations Research Best Video Award

Invited Talks

2027: Department of Health Services Research, The University of Texas MD Anderson Cancer Center (forthcoming)

2026: Harvard-wide Fellowship in Pediatric Health Services Research, Harvard Medical School (forthcoming)

2024: Center for Suicide Research and Prevention, Mass General Brigham and Harvard University

Conference Presentations

2026: Decision Science Institute (forthcoming; invited); INFORMS Annual Meeting (forthcoming; invited); INFORMS Healthcare Conference (invited); POMS Annual Conference (contributed); IOE-ISyE-MS&E Rising Stars Workshop, University of Michigan (contributed); Harvard GSAS Three Minute Thesis Finals (contributed)
2025: INFORMS Annual Meeting (two invited talks)
2024: Society for Medical Decision Making Annual Meeting (contributed); INFORMS Annual Meeting (invited)
2023: INFORMS Annual Meeting (invited); INFORMS Healthcare Conference (invited)

Teaching

Economics for Public Policy, Harvard Kennedy School
Instructor of Record, PPIA Junior Summer Institute, 2024–2026 (3x)

Math Camp for Incoming PhD Students, Harvard Kennedy School
Instructor of Record, 2023–2026 (4x)

Decision Science for Public Health, Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health
Teaching Fellow, 2023–2026 (4x)

Machine Learning and Big Data Analytics, Harvard Kennedy School
Teaching Fellow, 2023–2025 (4x)

Game Theory and Strategic Decisions, Harvard Kennedy School
Teaching Fellow, 2023, 2024, 2026 (3x)

Resources, Incentives, and Choices I: Markets and Market Failures, Harvard Kennedy School
Teaching Fellow, 2022–2025 (4x)

Data and Programming for Policymakers, Harvard Kennedy School
Teaching Fellow, 2023 (1x)

Data, Quantitative Methods, and Applications in Health Services Research, Center for Translational Science, University of Chicago
Co-Instructor, 2021–2023 (3x)

Coding Lab for Public Policy, Harris School of Public Policy, University of Chicago
Instructor of Record, 2021 (1x)

Machine Learning for Public Policy, Department of Computer Science, University of Chicago
Teaching Assistant, 2022 (1x)

Mathematics for Data Analysis and Computer Science, Department of Computer Science, University of Chicago
Teaching Assistant, 2022 (1x)

Introductory Finance, Booth School of Business, University of Chicago
Teaching Assistant, 2020–2022 (3x)

Data Analysis in R and Python, Booth School of Business, University of Chicago
Teaching Assistant, 2022 (1x)

Professional Experience

VA Greater Los Angeles Healthcare System, Department of Veterans Affairs
Research Statistician (Without Compensation appointment), 2026–present

Aerospace Technical Services
Health Policy Consultant, 2025–present

Division of Pharmacoepidemiology and Pharmacoeconomics, Department of Medicine, Brigham and Women's Hospital & Harvard Medical School
Research Trainee, 2024–present

Center for Health and the Social Sciences, University of Chicago
Data Scientist, 2020–2022

Teach For America, Achievement First Amistad Academy
7th/8th Grade Mathematics Teacher, 2018–2020

Academic Service

Leadership:
2026–2027: Short Course Co-Chair, SMDM Annual Meeting
2026: Teaching Statistics in the Age of Agentic AI, Harvard Kennedy School Workshop, Organizing Team
2022–2024: Health Applications Society Student Liaison, INFORMS

Session chair:
2025: INFORMS Annual Meeting (Atlanta, GA)
2024: INFORMS Annual Meeting (Seattle, WA; two sessions)
2023: INFORMS Annual Meeting (Phoenix, AZ); INFORMS Healthcare Conference (Toronto, ON)

Short courses and workshops:
2026: Build Your Own RA (Research Agent): Introduction to Agentic Coding and Custom Research Workflows, SMDM Virtual Workshop (Instructor)
2024: An Introduction to Reproducible Programming and Project Management, SMDM Annual Meeting (Instructor)
2023: Transparent Programming: Important Habits for Reproducibility and Research Integrity, SMDM Annual Meeting (Instructor)

Peer review:
Journals: Psychiatry Research; Medical Decision Making; Journal of Public Health and Emergency
Conferences: Society for Medical Decision Making Annual Meeting; International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC^2S^2)

Professional Memberships

Institute for Operations Research and the Management Sciences (INFORMS); Society for Medical Decision Making (SMDM)

Software Skills

R, Python, Stata, SQL; D3, Git, Docker, TreeAge

Additional Information

Hobbies and Interests
Birding, trivia, scary movies